

6/27 - Kenneth Hinkle

Context: Part 139 airport — so wildlife hazard management, airfield/pavement/lighting inspections, perimeter, ARFF, and an FAA-required UAS response plan are all part of his world. The FAA now even supports drones for wildlife dispersal. He controls his airspace, which makes a drone pilot realistic.

I'd love to start with your world — day to day, what does keeping Augusta Regional safe and running actually involve on the airfield side?

How do you handle perimeter and fence-line today — staff patrols, fixed cameras, a mix? **What part of it eats the most time or staff?**

Pain points

3. Part 139 keeps you busy with wildlife and airfield inspections — how are you handling wildlife monitoring and dispersal right now, and how well is that working?
4. When a fence sensor or alarm goes off at 2am, what happens — who drives out to look, and how long until someone has eyes on it?
5. FOD, lighting, pavement, signage checks — how much of that is still someone driving the field on a schedule?
6. Where do you feel most exposed — after-hours intrusion, the back fence line, wildlife, something else?

Drones / UAS at the airport

7. Do you run any drones today — inspection, wildlife, anything? If so, how's it going; if not, what's held it back?
8. You actually control the airspace here, which most sites don't — does that make scheduled drone patrols easier for you, or are there coordination headaches I'm not seeing?

Fit

10. If you could have a drone automatically fly the fence line or go check a sensor alarm and send you the video — would that change how you staff overnight, or is the real bottleneck somewhere else?

Close — gauge pilot interest

11. We're choosing a small number of pilot sites to prove this out, and an airport like Augusta is exactly where we'd learn the most. Would you be open to a limited pilot — say scheduled perimeter and wildlife patrols over a few weeks?